8-Week Home Workout Plan for Fat Loss (back-friendly, 3 kg dumbbells)

Starting point

Item	Value
Height	171 cm
Weight	65–66 kg
BMI	~22.4 (normal range)
Daily steps	~1,000 (very low)
Equipment	Pair of 3 kg dumbbells
Back	Mild lower-lumbar disc bulge, sacralisation (L5–S1), currently stable
Flexibility	Very tight hamstrings

What this means: your weight is already in the healthy range, so the goal is to lose fat (a realistic target is 61–63 kg) while keeping muscle. Your biggest problem isn't a lack of workouts. It's that you barely move during the day, at about 1k steps. Walking more will burn more calories than any single workout, so **steps are the #1 priority**. Walking is also one of the best things you can do for a disc bulge.

Realistic rate: **0.25–0.5 kg per week**, or about 2–4 kg over 8 weeks.

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0. Back rules (read first)

With a disc bulge and sacralisation, the lowest part of your spine handles load less well. The plan follows these rules:

1. **Neutral spine under load.** Every exercise keeps your lower back in its natural curve. Bend at the hips, not the waist.
2. **No sit-ups, crunches, Russian twists, toe touches, or seated forward folds.** Repeated or loaded bending and twisting of the spine is the main thing that aggravates a disc bulge.
3. **No jumping for the first 4 weeks.** Cardio is low-impact.
4. **No back exercises in the first hour after waking.** Discs are most swollen then. Walking is fine.
5. **Brace before each rep.** Tighten your stomach as if someone were about to poke it, and keep breathing. Don't suck your stomach in.
6. **Pain rule:** mild muscle soreness is fine. Back pain above 3/10 during or after a session means you stop that exercise and go back one level.
7. **Stop and see a doctor right away** if you get pain, numbness or tingling down a leg, weakness in a foot, or any change in bladder or bowel control.

It's worth having a physiotherapist check your form once, especially the hip hinge.

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1. Daily step targets (most important)

Week	Daily step target	How
1–2	3,000–4,000	10-min walk after each meal
3–4	5,000–6,000	Add one 20-min walk
5–6	7,000–8,000	Walk during phone calls, take stairs
7–8	8,000–10,000	One 30–40 min brisk walk daily

If you can’t go outside, march or walk in place indoors. 10 minutes is roughly 1,000–1,200 steps. Also get up and move for 2–3 minutes every 30–45 minutes of sitting. Long sitting stresses the disc.

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2. Daily plan

You train every day, but the days rotate so the same muscles always get 48 hours of rest.

Day	Session	Time
Mon	Daily back routine + **Lower body**	35–40 min
Tue	Daily back routine + **Upper body**	35–40 min
Wed	Daily back routine + **Hamstring & hip mobility** + long walk	20 min + walk
Thu	Daily back routine + **Lower body**	35–40 min
Fri	Daily back routine + **Upper body**	35–40 min
Sat	Daily back routine + **Low-impact cardio circuit**	25 min
Sun	Daily back routine only + walk	10 min + walk

Warm-up (5 min, before Mon/Tue/Thu/Fri/Sat sessions)

March in place 1 min, arm circles 30s, cat-cow ×8 (gentle, small range), hip circles while standing ×10 each way, bodyweight box squat to a chair ×10.

Daily back routine (every day, ~10 min)

This is a core routine designed for disc problems. It builds endurance in the muscles that hold your spine still without bending it.

Exercise	How	Weeks 1–2	Weeks 3–4	Weeks 5–8
Modified curl-up	On your back, one knee bent, hands under your lower back. Lift only your head and shoulders 2–3 cm. Hold.	5×8s	6×10s	4-3-2 reps of 10s holds
Side plank (knees bent)	Hips forward, straight line from knees to head	3×10s each side	4×10s	5×10s, then progress to straight legs
Bird dog	On hands and knees, extend opposite arm and leg, keep hips level	6×8s each side	8×10s	10×10s
Glute bridge	Squeeze glutes, don’t arch your lower back at the top	2×12	2×15	2×15 with 3s hold

Lower body (Mon & Thu)

3 kg is light, so these use slow lowering (3 seconds down) and single-leg work to make it harder.

Exercise	Weeks 1–2	Weeks 3–4	Weeks 5–8
Goblet box squat (hold 1 dumbbell at chest, sit back to a chair)	3×10	3×12, 3s down	4×12, 3s down, lower chair
Glute bridge (dumbbell on hips)	3×15	3×12 single-leg (each)	4×12 single-leg, 2s hold
Hip hinge / Romanian deadlift (both dumbbells)	3×8 bodyweight, hands on hips, small range	3×10 with dumbbells, stop when hamstrings tighten	3×12, 3s down
Reverse lunge (dumbbells at sides, hold a wall if needed)	2×8 each leg	3×10	3×12
Side-lying leg raise	2×12 each side	3×15	3×15 with 2s hold
Calf raise (dumbbells, on a step)	3×15	3×20	3×15 single-leg

Romanian deadlift form: soft knees, push your hips back as if closing a car door with your bottom, dumbbells slide down your thighs, chest proud. Your hamstrings are tight, so you may only reach just above your knees. That’s correct. **Don’t round your back to go lower.**

Upper body (Tue & Fri)

Exercise	Weeks 1–2	Weeks 3–4	Weeks 5–8
Push-up (incline on bed/table → floor)	3×8 incline	3×10 lower incline	4×8–12 floor (or knees)
Single-arm row, one hand and knee supported on a chair or bed	3×12 each arm	3×15	4×15, 2s squeeze at top
Overhead press (seated, back supported, or standing with glutes squeezed)	3×10	3×12	3×15
Floor chest press (on your back, knees bent)	3×12	3×15	3×15, 3s down
Lateral raise	2×12	3×12	3×15
Biceps curl + overhead triceps extension (standing, ribs down)	2×12 each	3×12	3×15
Dead bug (low back stays pressed to floor)	3×6 each side	3×8	3×10 holding dumbbell

Rest 45–75s between sets. When the top of a rep range feels easy, move to the harder column. Don’t add sets just because 3 kg feels light. Use slower tempo instead.

Low-impact cardio circuit (Sat)

40s work / 20s rest, 4 rounds (weeks 1–4) → 5 rounds (weeks 5–8). 1 min rest between rounds. 1. Fast march with arm swings 2. Step-jacks (step out side to side, arms overhead) 3. Goblet squat to chair, 1 dumbbell 4. Standing alternate knee to opposite elbow, slow, without bending your spine 5. Shadow boxing, light dumbbells in hand

A 30–40 min brisk walk is an equally good replacement on any day.

Hamstring & hip mobility (Wed, and 5 min after any session)

Tight hamstrings in people with disc bulges are often partly a protective nerve response, so stretch **gently**. Never bounce, and never stretch by bending forward from the waist.

Stretch	How	Dose
Lying hamstring stretch with towel	On your back, loop a towel around one foot, raise the straight leg until you feel a mild stretch. Other knee bent.	3×30s each leg
Legs up the wall	Lie with bottom close to a wall, legs up. Relax.	2–3 min
Half-kneeling hip flexor stretch	Squeeze the glute on the back-knee side, shift forward slightly	2×30s each side
Figure-4 glute stretch, lying down	Ankle on opposite knee, pull the thigh toward you	2×30s each side
Nerve glide (sciatic floss)	Sitting tall, straighten one knee while lifting your head, bend the knee while dropping your chin. Smooth, not a stretch.	10 each leg
Prone press-up (only if it feels good)	Lie on your stomach, press your chest up with hips down, gently	10 slow reps

Skip the nerve glide and press-up if either causes leg symptoms.

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3. Nutrition (this drives fat loss)

- **Small deficit:** eat ~300–500 kcal below maintenance. Don’t crash diet.
- **Protein:** ~100–110 g/day (about 1.6 g per kg). Sources: eggs, paneer, dal, chicken, fish, curd/Greek yogurt, soya chunks, tofu.
- Fill half your plate with vegetables. Cut back on sugary drinks, fried snacks and late-night eating.
- Water: 2.5–3 L/day (discs need hydration too). Sleep: 7–8 hours.

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4. My history (track here)

Weigh yourself on the same scale, in the morning after using the toilet, 3–4×/week. Track the **weekly average** because daily weight swings by ±1 kg.

Weekly log

Week	Dates	Avg weight (kg)	Waist at navel (cm)	Avg daily steps	Sessions done (/7)	Back pain (0–10)	Notes
0 (start)	2026-10-23	65.5		~1,000	–	stable	Baseline. Disc bulge + sacralisation, tight hamstrings
1							
2							
3							
4							
5							
6							
7							
8							

Strength & flexibility progress

Test	Week 1	Week 4	Week 8
Push-ups (max reps, type)			
Goblet box squat, 3 kg (max reps)			
Single-leg glute bridge (max reps, each)			
Side plank (max seconds, each)			
Bird dog (seconds holding level, each)			
Straight-leg raise lying down (how high: shin / knee / thigh)			

Rules for adjusting

- Weekly average not dropping for 2 weeks → add 1,500 steps/day **or** cut ~150 kcal.
- Losing more than 0.75 kg/week → eat a little more (to protect muscle).
- Waist shrinking while weight stays the same → that’s fat loss. Keep going.
- Back pain rises above 3/10 or lasts into the next morning → drop back one level for a week and replace the cardio circuit with walking.
- Once 3 kg feels easy at the top of every range (around week 6–8), heavier dumbbells (5–8 kg) are the next step.

This plan is general guidance, not medical advice. Because of your disc bulge and sacralisation, please run it past your doctor or physiotherapist before starting.